John R. Starr

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

2026 – Present	Post-doctoral Fellow (PI: Jennifer Hu) Department of Cognitive Science	Johns Hopkins University

EDUCATION

2020 – 2026	Ph.D. Linguistics (Advisor: Marten van Schijndel) Dissertation: *Dynamic interaction of linguistic streams during processing: a computational psycholinguistic approach*	Cornell University
2023	M.A. Linguistics	Cornell University
2020	B.A. Linguistics, B.A. English Writing (Minor: Persian)	University of Pittsburgh

PUBLICATIONS

2025	| **John R. Starr** & Marten van Schijndel. "Losing phonotactic distinctions in context." *Cognitive Science.* [https://doi.org/10.1111/cogs.70059]
	| **John R. Starr**, Ashlyn Winship, & Marten van Schijndel. "Generating representations in space with GRIS." *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (*CogSci2025).* [link]
2024	| Jacob Matthews, **John R. Starr**, & Marten van Schijndel. "Semantics or spelling? Probing contextual word embeddings with orthographic noise." In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics 2024*. [link]
2023	| **John R. Starr** & Marten van Schijndel. "Discourse context modulates phonotactic processing." In *Supplemental Proceedings of the 2023 Annual Meeting on Phonology.*
resubmitted	| **John R. Starr**, Ashlyn Winship, & Marten van Schijndel. "Approximating Cognitive Representations Using Space." *Open Mind*.
revise & resubmit	| **John R. Starr**, Helena Aparicio, & Marten van Schijndel. "Rational use of phonological cues during processing: evidence from rhyme." *Glossa Psycholinguistics.*

EDITED VOLUMES

2022 | **John R. Starr**, Juhyae Kim, & Burak Öney (eds.). *Proceedings of the 32nd Semantics and Linguistic Theory Conference (SALT32)*. El Colegio de Mexico (COLMEX) & the Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México (UNAM).

2021 | Nicole Dreier, Chloe Kwon, Thomas Darnell, & **John R. Starr** (eds.). *Proceedings of the 31st Semantics and Linguistic Theory Conference (SALT31)*. Brown University.

INVITED TALKS

2026 | "Everything everywhere incrementally" *Group for Language & Intelligence*. Johns Hopkins University. [Virtual]

2024 | "Trending toward a contextual psycholinguistics" *Breiss Lab*. University of Southern California. [Virtual]

| "Bust or robust? Unpacking Representational Sensitivity of Modern Vector Representations" *Columbia University NLP Group.*

| "What can natural language processing tell us about human language processing?" *University of Pittsburgh Python for Linguists (PyLing).* [Virtual]

2022 | "A first look at mind rhymes." *The Berkeley Phonetics, Phonology, and Psycholinguistics Forum (PHORUM).* [Virtual]

PRESENTATIONS (PEER-REVIEWED ABSTRACT)

2026 | **John R. Starr** & Marten van Schijndel. "Modeling reading by interpolating predictions from *n*-grams & lossy sentence memories." The *39th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP).* Oral.

2025 | **John R. Starr**, Ashlyn Winship, & Marten van Schijndel. "Generating representations in space with GRIS." *The 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (*CogSci2025).*

| **John R. Starr** & Marten van Schijndel. "Focus reveals how people (variably) update event representations to novel material." The *4th Workshop on Processing and Evaluating Event Representations (PEER).*

| Ashlyn Winship, Zander Lynch, **John R. Starr**, Yifan Wu, Lucas Li, & Marten van Schijndel. "Experimentally extracting implicit instruments." The *4th Workshop on Processing and Evaluating Event Representations (PEER).*

| **John R. Starr** & Marten van Schijndel. "Focus reveals how people (variably) update event representations to novel material." The *38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP).*

| Ashlyn Winship, Zander Lynch, **John R. Starr**, Yifan Wu, Lucas Li, & Marten van Schijndel. "Experimentally extracting implicit instruments." The *38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP).*

2024

| **John R. Starr** & Marten van Schijndel. "Contexts let you flop and flip binomials" The *30th Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP) Conference*.

| Jacob Matthews, **John R. Starr**, & Marten van Schijndel. "Semantics or spelling? Probing contextual word embeddings with orthographic noise." The *62nd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL).*

2023

| **John R. Starr** & Marten van Schijndel. "Discourse context modulates phonotactic processing." The *2023 Annual Meeting on Phonology.*

| **John R. Starr**, Helena Aparicio, & Marten van Schijndel. "The relationship between phonological viability and syntactic complexity." The *30th Manchester Phonology Meeting (30mfm).*

| **John R. Starr**, Helena Aparicio, & Marten van Schijndel. "Salient phonological information modulates the effect of semantic priming in prediction." The *36th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP).*

| **John R. Starr**, Helena Aparicio, Marten van Schijndel, & Draga Zec. "Phonological structure influences incremental syntactic processing." The *36th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP).*

2022

| **John R. Starr**, Helena Aparicio, & Marten van Schijndel. "Semantics reels us in: A first look at mind rhymes." The *35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP).*

OTHER PRESENTATIONS (NON-PEER REVIEWED ABSTRACT)

2024 | **John R. Starr**. "Situating phonological phenomena within events." The *3rd Workshop on Processing and Evaluating Event Representations (PEER).*

2022 | **John R. Starr**, Helena Aparicio, & Marten van Schijndel. "Subversive verses alter alternatives: Mind rhyme and its implications on covert processing." The *1st Workshop on Processing and Evaluating Event Representations (PEER).*

TEACHING

Instructor of Record:

2025, 2023	Fall	LING1101: *How We're Laughter Crafters*	Cornell University

Teaching Assistant: (* = Head GTA for UTAs)

2025	Fall	LING1170 | CS1710: *Introduction to Cognitive Science* `	Cornell University
2024	Spring	LING4424/6624 | CS4744: *Computational Linguistics I*	Cornell University
2023	Spring	LING4424/6624 | CS4744: *Computational Linguistics I*	Cornell University
2022	Fall	*CS5740/4740: *Natural Language Processing*	Cornell University
	Spring	LING1170 | CS1710: *Introduction to Cognitive Science*	Cornell University
2021	Fall	LING3303: *Introduction to Syntax and Semantics*	Cornell University
2020	Spring	LING2340/1340: *Data Science for Linguists*	University of Pittsburgh
2019	Spring	LING1000: *Introduction to Linguistics*	University of Pittsburgh

AWARDS

2026	Toni Morrison Award in Outstanding Graduate Mentorship	$0
2026	Provost Diversity Scholarship	$17,190
2025	Stephen Russell Family Teaching Award	$2,500
2024, 2021	Cornell Cognitive Science Graduate Research Award	$1,000
2023	Cornell Graduate School Graduate Travel Award	$750
	Cornell Cognitive Science Graduate Travel Award	$750
2022	Outstanding Graduate Teaching Assistant (Computer Science)	$0
2020, 2025	Sage Fellowship	$73,000
2020-2025	Beinecke Scholarship	$34,000

SERVICE

2024-2026	Student Representative	LSA Executive Committee
2023-2026	Writing Coach	Cornell Office of Academic Discovery & Impact (OADI)
2023-2024	President	Cornell Linguistics Circle
2022-2023	Graduate Student Representative	Faculty search committee in Phonology
2021-2022	Social Chair	Cornell Linguistics Circle
2020-2022	Organizer	Cornell University Department of Linguistics Open House

REVIEWING

Journals:	Journal of Memory and Language (JML)
Conferences:	Penn Linguistics Conference, Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Workshop on Processing and Evaluating Event Representations (PEER)

EMPLOYMENT

2018-2020	Linguistic Data Intern	*Voci Technologies*
2019	LORELEI Assistant	*Carnegie Mellon University*

LANGUAGES

Native: English

Advanced: Persian

Programming: Python & R

RESEARCH INTERESTS

psycholinguistics, computational linguistics, language modeling, information theory, natural language processing, phonology, priming, dynamical modeling, poetics, humor

References available upon request